Riccardo Venturini, Psychologist

Contacts

Laboratory of Neurolinguistics and Experimental Pragmatics (NEP), Department of Humanities and Life Sciences

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Education

OCT 2024 - ONGOING | UNIVERSITY SCHOOL FOR ADVANCED STUDIES IUSS, PAVIA

PhD in Theoretical and Experimental Linguistics

Research topics: M/EEG data analysis, neurolinguistics, naturalistic speech comprehension

Supervisor: Prof. Valentina Bambini (IUSS Pavia)

OCT 2021 - OCT 2023 | UNIVERSITY OF TRENTO, ROVERETO

MSc in Psychology (Neuroscience)

Grade: 110/110 cum laude.
Thesis: "Samples from data quality and data reliability assessment and validation of blindTHINGS dataset"
Supervisors: Prof. Martin Hebart (MPI CBS), Prof. Roberto Bottini (UniTn)

OCT 2018 - JUL 2021 | UNIVERSITY OF PADUA, PADUA

BSc in Psychology

Grade: 110/110 cum laude.
Thesis: "Genuine and simulated emotions: kinematics of Duchenne Smile symmetry"
Supervisor: Prof. Luisa Sartori (UniPd)

SEP 2016 - AUG 2018 | CENTRAL FOUNDATION BOYS' SCHOOL, LONDON

Advanced Level in Maths, Biology, Physics and History

SEP 2013 - JUN 2016 | LICEO SCIENTIFICO STATALE "NICCOLÒ COPERNICO", UDINE

Secondary School

Internships and Training Experience

OCT 2024 - ONGOING | UNIVERSITY SCHOOL FOR ADVANCED STUDIES IUSS, PAVIA

PhD student

My research at NEPLab focuses on the analysis of electrophysiological data to investigate the neural mechanisms underlying language processing, with a particular emphasis on naturalistic speech comprehension. I have experience with a range of M/EEG analysis methods, from event-related potentials to multivariate approaches such as time-resolved decoding, as well as functional connectivity analysis.
Supervisor: Prof. Valentina Bambini (IUSS Pavia)
Co-supervisor: Dott. Federico Frau (IUSS Pavia)

OCT 2023 - SEP 2024 | S. CHIARA UNIVERSITY HOSPITAL, TRENTO

Postgraduate qualifying internship in Neuropsychology

Neurosurgery Unit: neuropsychological assessment of brain tumour patients, advanced neuroimaging analyses (i.e. virtual in vivo dissection and resting state functional connectivity analysis) for awake surgery planning and intraoperative functional mapping.
Physical Medicine and Rehabilitation Unit: design and implementation of rehabilitation programs with patients with severe acquired brain injuries.
Supervisor: Luca Zigiotto, PsyD (UniTn)

SEP 2022 - SEP 2023 | UNIVERSITY OF TRENTO, ROVERETO

Graduate curricular internship

Neurobiology of Conceptual Knowledge Group: replication study of an experiment investigating unconscious semantic processing. Acquisition of fMRI data on blind participants and sighted controls for the understanding of semantics in sensory deprived participants.
Supervisor: Prof. Roberto Bottini (UniTn)

APR 2022 - OCT 2022 | UNIVERSITY OF TRENTO, ROVERETO

Research internship

Affiliative Behaviour and Psychology Laboratory: assessment of the predictability of infant development using data from the UNICEF MICS questionnaire on water quality in low- to middle-income countries using scikit-learn and mics-library.
Supervisor: Dott. Andrea Bizzego (UniTn)

SEP 2020 - JUL 2021 | UNIVERSITY OF PADUA, PADUA

Undergraduate curricular internship

Neuroscience of Movement Laboratory: Tridimensional kinetic marking and analysis of elicited or simulated emotions according to the FACS.
Supervisor: Prof. Luisa Sartori (UniPd)

Training and Visiting Experience Abroad

JUN 2023 - SEP 2023 | MAX PLANCK INSTITUTE FOR HUMAN COGNITIVE AND BRAIN SCIENCES, LEIPZIG

Erasmus+ Thesis/reseach Traineeship

Vision and Computational Cognition Group: quality control, quality assessment and validation of a deep-imaging-approach fMRI dataset on blind participants and sighted controls for the understanding of semantics in sensory deprived participants.
Supervisor: Prof. Martin Hebart (MPI CBS)

JAN 2026 - APR 2026 | GOETHE UNIVERSITY FRANKFURT, FRANKFURT AM MAIN

Visiting doctoral research period

People's Lab: time-resolved neural decoding of hierarchical linguistic processing during naturalistic speech comprehension from EEG using a back-to-back regression framework.
Supervisor: Dr. Alessandro Tavano (GU)

Summer Schools and Workshops

OCT 2025 | AIX-MARSEILLE UNIVERSITY, AIX-EN-PROVENCE

PracticalMEEG

Intensive theoretical and hands-on training in M/EEG analysis, covering preprocessing, source analysis, and group-level statistics.

JUN 2024 | S. CHIARA UNIVERSITY HOSPITAL, TRENTO

Connect Brain Vol. III

Theoretical and practical course on clinical and surgical applications of structural and functional connectivity.

JUL 2024 - AUG 2024 | UNIVERITY OF PISA

Summer School

European Summer School in Sensory Neuroscience.

MAR 2023 | PARIS BRAIN INSTITUTE

EBRAINS Workshop

Anatomy and function of the prefrontal cortex across species.

Publications

SCIENTIFIC ARTICLES

Zigiotto, L., **Venturini, R.**, Coletta, L., Venturini, M., Dal Monte, D., Vavassori, L., Corsini, F., Annicchiarico, L., Avesani, P., Papagno, C., Sarubbo, S. (2025) Maximizing Tumor Resection and Managing Cognitive Attentional Outcomes: Measures of Impact of Awake Surgery in Glioma Treatment. *Neurosurgery*, 10-1227.
doi: 10.1227/neu.0000000000003591

ABSTRACTS TO CONFERENCES (AS PRESENTER)

Venturini, R., Frau, F., Canal, P., Aubonnet, R., Agostoni, G., Arcara, G., Cavallaro, R., Di Lorenzo, G., Bosia, M., Bambini, V. Changes in EEG beta functional connectivity during narrative listening reflect linguistic-pragmatic impairment in schizophrenia. SIPF Annual Congress - “The adaptive brain”, Verona (Italy), 17-19 September 2025. [Poster presentation]

Frau, F., **Venturini, R.**, Canal, P., Aubonnet, R., Agostoni, G., Arcara, G., Cavallaro, R., Di Lorenzo, G., Bosia, M., Bambini, V. Changes in EEG beta functional connectivity during narrative listening reflect linguistic-pragmatic impairment in schizophrenia. SNL 17th Annual Meeting, Washington DC (United States), 12-14 September 2025. [Poster presentation]

Venturini, R., Frau, F., Canal, P., Aubonnet, R., Agostoni, G., Arcara, G., Cavallaro, R., Di Lorenzo, G., Bosia, M., Bambini, V. Changes in EEG beta functional connectivity during narrative listening reflect linguistic-pragmatic impairment in schizophrenia. PracticalMEEG 2025, Aix-en-Provence (France), 27-31 October 2025. [Poster presentation]

ABSTRACTS TO CONFERENCES (AS CO-AUTHOR)

Frau, F., Canal, P., Luciani, F., **Venturini, R.**, Bischetti, L., Bambini, V. A key to interpreting late effects in the brain response to metaphors: priming figurative (but not literal) meaning. 11th XPRAG Conference, Cambridge (United Kingdom), 17-19 September 2025. [Oral presentation]

Canal, P., Frau, F., Luciani, F., **Venturini, R.**, Bischetti, L., Bambini, V. A key to interpreting late effects in the brain response to metaphors: priming figurative (but not literal) meaning. 31st AMLaP Conference, Prague (Czechia), 4-6 September 2025. [Poster presentation]

Honors, Awards, and Funding

International Mobility Grant (EFC Project), IUSS School for Advanced Studies Pavia

Competitive PNRR-funded (Next Generation EU) grant for research visit at Goethe University Frankfurt (Germany), €1250/month for 4 months

Attended Conferences

MARCH 2026 | PAVIA

DISCOURSE IN PSYCHOSIS

4th Consortium Satellite Meeting - “Language and though in the brain and in mental health”

FEB 2025 | MILANO

ITRN Annual Meeting

4th Italian Reproducibility Network meeting - “Open science and inclusivity”

SEP 2024 | VENEZIA

XPRAG.it

5th Experimental Pragmatics in Italy Conference

MAY 2024 | ROVERETO

CIMeC Workshop

Concepts, Actions and Objects: Functional and Neural Perspectives

APRIL 2024 | ROVERETO

SIPO Interregional Conference

Communication in psycho-oncology

MAY 2023 | ROVERETO

CIMeC Workshop

Concepts, Actions and Objects: Functional and Neural Perspectives

MAY 2022 | FIRENZE

ITRN Annual Meeting

1st Italian Reproducibility Network meeting - "Trying and trying again"

Participation to Research Activities

OCT 2024 - ONGOING | UNIVERSITY SCHOOL FOR ADVANCED STUDIES IUSS, PAVIA

PROcessing MEtaphors: Neurochronometry, Acquisition and Decay (PROMENADE), ERC Consolidator Grant, project number 101045733

Funded by the European Research Council (ERC)
PI: Prof. Valentina Bambini.

OCT 2024 - ONGOING | UNIVERSITY SCHOOL FOR ADVANCED STUDIES IUSS, PAVIA

The Fragility of Metaphors (FraMe): learning, loosing, and how to train them, PRIN (Progetti di Ricerca di Rilevante Interesse Nazionale), project number 2022289RNA

Funded by the Italian Ministry of Research
PI: Prof. Valentina Bambini.

OCT 2023 - SEP 2024 | OSPEDALE SANTA CHIARA, TRENTO

NeuSurPlan: an integrated approach to neurosurgery planning based on multimodal data, Neurosurgery Unit

Funded by the Autonomous Province of Trento
PI: Prof. Silvio Sarubbo.

In compliance with the Italian legislative Decree no. 196 dated 30/06/2003 and the General Data Protection Regulation (EU) n. 2016/679, I hereby authorize the recipient of this document to use and process my personal details for the purpose of recruiting and selecting staff.

Frankfurt am Main, 16/04/2026

Riccardo Vertuani